

# MARISSA E. THOMPSON

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## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Stratification & Inequality • Sociology of Education • Race & Ethnicity • Social Policy

## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

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| <b>Columbia University</b><br>Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology<br>Co-Director, Center for the Study of Wealth and Inequality<br>Faculty Affiliate, Columbia Population Research Center | 2022-     |
| <b>University of Michigan</b><br>Postdoctoral Fellow, Education Policy Initiative, Ford School of Public Policy<br>Research Affiliate, Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics                        | 2021-2022 |

## EDUCATION

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| <b>Ph.D., Sociology of Education &amp; Education Policy</b><br>Stanford University                           | 2021 |
| <b>M.A., Sociology</b><br>Stanford University                                                                | 2019 |
| <b>B.S.E., Chemical and Biomolecular Engineering</b><br><i>magna cum laude</i><br>University of Pennsylvania | 2016 |

## PUBLICATIONS

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\* denotes equal authorship

### Peer-Reviewed Publications:

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| 2024 | <b>Marissa E. Thompson</b> , Tobias Dalberg, and Elizabeth E. Bruch. “Gender Segregation and Decision-Making in Undergraduate Course-Taking.” <i>Sociological Science</i> . [Paper] [Data/Code]                                                                                                                             |
| 2024 | <b>Marissa E. Thompson</b> . “The Effect of Academic Outcomes, Equity, and Student Demographics on Parental Preferences for Schools: Evidence from a Survey Experiment.” <i>Social Forces</i> . [Paper] [Data/Code] [Pre-Registration]<br>• Best Post-PhD Paper Award (Co-Winner), Sociology of Education Association, 2025 |
| 2024 | <b>Marissa E. Thompson*</b> and Sam Trejo*. “My School District Isn’t Segregated: Experimental Evidence on the Effect of Information on Parental Preferences Regarding School Segregation.” <i>Sociology of Education</i> . [Paper] [Data/Code] [Pre-Registration]                                                          |
| 2024 | <b>Marissa E. Thompson</b> . “Examining the Black Gender Gap in Educational Attainment: The Role of Exclusionary School Discipline & Criminal Justice Contact.” <i>Social Forces</i> . [Paper]                                                                                                                              |
| 2023 | <b>Marissa E. Thompson</b> , Christina Weiland, Meghan P. McCormick, Catherine Snow, and Jason                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

Sachs. “The Role of Early Schooling in Shaping Inequality in Academic, Executive Functioning, and Social-Emotional Skills.” *Socius*. [Paper]

- 2023 René F. Kizilcec, Rachel B. Baker, Elizabeth Bruch, Kalena E. Cortes, Laura T. Hamilton, David Nathan Lang, Zachary A. Pardos, **Marissa E. Thompson**, and Mitchell L. Stevens. “From Pipelines to Pathways in the Study of Academic Progress.” *Science* (Policy Forum). [Paper]
- 2023 Kaylee T. Matheny\*, **Marissa E. Thompson\***, Carrie Townley-Flores\*, and Sean F. Reardon. “Uneven Progress: Recent Trends in Academic Performance Among U.S. School Districts.” *American Education Research Journal*. [Paper]
- 2021 **Marissa E. Thompson**. “Grade Expectations: The Role of First-Year Grades in Predicting the Pursuit of STEM Majors for First- and Continuing-Generation Students.” *The Journal of Higher Education*. [Paper]
- 2021 Sorathan Chaturapruek, Tobias Dalberg, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Sonia Giebel, Monique H. Harrison, Ramesh Johari, Mitchell L. Stevens, and René Kizilcec. “Studying Undergraduate Course Consideration at Scale.” *AERA Open*. [Paper] [Data/Code]
- 2020 Adina D. Sterling, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Shiya Wang, Abisola Kusimo, Shannon Gilmartin, and Sheri Sheppard. “The Confidence Gap Predicts the Gender Pay Gap Among STEM Graduates.” *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. [Paper]
- 2019 Shannon Gilmartin, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Emily Morton, Helen Chen, Anne Colby, and Sheri Sheppard. “Entrepreneurial Intent of Engineering and Business Undergraduate Students.” *Journal of Engineering Education*. [Paper]
- 2016 Ki Jun Yu, Duygu Kuzum, Suk Won Hwang, Bong Hoon Kim, Halvor Juul, Nam Heon Kim, Sang Min Won, Ken Chiang, Michael Trumpis, Andrew G. Richardson, Huanyu Cheng, Hui Fang, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Hank Bink, Delia Talos, Kyung Jin Seo, Hee Nam Lee, Seung Kyun Kang, Jae Hwan Kim, Jung Yup Lee, Younggang Huang, Frances E. Jensen, Marc A. Dichter, Timothy H. Lucas, Jonathan Viventi, Brian Litt, and John A. Rogers. “Bioresorbable Silicon Electronics for Transient Spatiotemporal Mapping of Electrical Activity from the Cerebral Cortex.” *Nature Materials*. [Paper]

### Working Papers & Manuscripts Under Review:

**Marissa E. Thompson**, Sam Trejo, AJ Alvero, and Daphne O. Martschenko. “‘*They have Black in their Blood*’: Exploring how Genetic Ancestry Tests affect Conceptions of Race.” Revise & resubmit, *American Journal of Sociology*. [Preprint] [Pre-Registration]

**Marissa E. Thompson**. “*Paper, Practice, Ancestry, Culture*: Racial frames and contested racial/ethnic census categories.” Revise & resubmit, *Social Forces*.

### Other Publications:

- 2021 **Marissa E. Thompson**. “Who’s getting pulled in weed-out courses for STEM majors?” Brown Center Chalkboard, Brookings Institution. [Link]

## GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

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|                                                                                                                                                                                                     |           |
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| Postdoctoral Fellowship, National Academy of Education & Spencer Foundation – \$70,000                                                                                                              | 2024-2025 |
| Russell Sage Foundation & Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation Pipeline Grant – \$35,000<br>for “ <i>What is fair? Disentangling public conceptions of merit and equity in the age of inequality</i> ” | 2024      |

P.I. Marissa Thompson

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| Hettelman Junior Faculty Summer Research Grant, Columbia University – \$6,000                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2024      |
| Alliance Joint Projects Grant, Columbia University & Sciences Po (Paris) – \$15,000<br>for “ <i>A Columbia-Sciences Po Joint Course: Race, Discrimination, and Racial Inequalities on Both Sides of the Atlantic</i> ”<br>P.I.s Thomas DiPrete, Mirna Safi & Marissa Thompson  | 2023      |
| Columbia Population Research Center Seed Grant, Columbia University – \$20,000<br>for “ <i>Race, Genetic Ancestry, and Context: Exploring How Genetic Ancestry Tests Influence Conceptions of Race</i> ”<br>P.I.s Marissa Thompson, Sam Trejo, Daphne Martschenko, & AJ Alvero | 2022      |
| Institute of Education Sciences (IES) Grant – \$2,702,034<br>for “ <i>Early First-Dollar Categorical Need-Based Aid: A New Model for Making College Affordable?</i> ”<br>P.I. Kevin Stange                                                                                     | 2022-2026 |
| Postdoctoral Training Fellowship, Institute of Education Sciences (IES) – \$55,000                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2021-2022 |
| Center for American Democracy Grant, Stanford University – \$2,000<br>for “ <i>Understanding Parental Attitudes Towards School Segregation</i> ”<br>P.I.s Marissa Thompson and Sam Trejo                                                                                       | 2020-2021 |
| Karr Family Fellowship, Stanford University – \$19,000                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 2018-2019 |
| Predocctoral Training Fellowship, Institute of Education Sciences (IES) – \$60,000                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2017-2019 |
| Graduate Fellowship in Science and Engineering, Stanford University – \$125,100                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2016-2021 |
| Enhancing Diversity in Graduate Education Fellowship, Stanford University – \$12,800                                                                                                                                                                                           | 2016-2021 |

## HONORS & AWARDS

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Outstanding Predocctoral Fellow Award, Institute of Education Sciences (IES)                   | 2021 |
| Zeisberg Best Research Award in Chemical Engineering, American Institute of Chemical Engineers | 2017 |
| Melvin C. Molstad Prize in Chemical Engineering, University of Pennsylvania                    | 2016 |
| Exceptional Service Award, University of Pennsylvania                                          | 2016 |

## RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

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### University of Chicago

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| Affiliate, Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality and Mobility | 2023-2027 |
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### Stanford University

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| Affiliate, Pathways Network | 2021- |
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## TEACHING

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### Columbia University

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Education and Inequality (Undergraduate)                                                     | Spring 2024                       |
| Race, Discrimination, and Racial Inequalities on Both Sides of the Atlantic (Undergraduate)* | Fall 2023                         |
| <i>*cross-listed with Sciences Po (Paris)</i>                                                |                                   |
| Sociology of Education (Graduate)                                                            | Fall 2022                         |
| Workshop on Wealth and Inequality (Graduate)                                                 | Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Spring 2024 |

## INVITED PRESENTATIONS

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(includes scheduled presentations)

- 2025    University of California Los Angeles, California Center for Population Research  
         Brown University, Annenberg Institute  
         Princeton University, Office of Population Research  
         Princeton University, Education Research Section
  
- 2024    University of Pennsylvania, Population Studies Center  
         ENSAE Paris, Center for Research in Economics and Statistics  
         Sciences Po Paris, Centre for Research on Social Inequalities  
         University of Chicago, Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality and Mobility  
         University of Oxford, Classical and Computational Social Science Working Group  
         Stanford University, Center for Education Policy Analysis  
         Stanford University, Educational Opportunity Project & Institute for Advancing Just Societies
  
- 2023    University of Michigan, Center for Academic Innovation  
         University of Houston, Identity & Academic Motivation Lab  
         Columbia University, Population Research Center  
         Pennsylvania State University, Population Research Institute  
         Yale University, Center for Empirical Research on Stratification and Inequality  
         University of Wisconsin - Madison, Wisconsin Center for Educational Research  
         University of Wisconsin - Madison, Experimental Methods in Sociology Workshop
  
- 2022    Columbia University, Center for the Study of Wealth and Inequality  
         Drexel University, Pennoni Honors College (Panel)  
         Pennsylvania State University, College of Education  
         Columbia University, Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences Research Seminar
  
- 2021    University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy  
         Howard University, School of Education  
         University of Florida, College of Education  
         Columbia University, Department of Sociology
  
- 2020    École Normale Supérieure, Département d'Études Cognitives

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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(includes scheduled presentations)

- 2025    Sociology of Education Association  
         Population Association of America  
         International Sociological Association

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|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 | Sociology of Education Association<br>American Sociological Association<br>Race & Ancestry Symposium (University of Pennsylvania)                                                |
| 2023 | Sociology of Education Association<br>Population Association of America<br>RC-28: Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility<br>American Sociological Association  |
| 2022 | American Sociological Association<br>Association of Black Sociologists                                                                                                           |
| 2021 | American Sociological Association<br>Association for Education Finance and Policy<br>Empowering Learners in AI                                                                   |
| 2020 | Association for the Study of Higher Education                                                                                                                                    |
| 2019 | Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management<br>Sociology of Education Association<br>Association for Education Finance and Policy<br>American Sociological Association |
| 2018 | American Society of Engineering Education<br>American Sociological Association                                                                                                   |

## DEPARTMENTAL & UNIVERSITY SERVICE

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|----------------------------------------------------|------|
| Graduate Admissions Committee, Columbia University | 2023 |
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### Student Advising:

#### *PhD Dissertation Committee*

Bonnie Siegler (Sociology, Columbia University, *exp.* 2025)  
Elizabeth Adetiba (Sociology, Columbia University, *exp.* 2025)  
Dominic Walker (Sociology, Columbia University, 2024)  
Asya Tsaturyan (Sociology, Columbia University, 2024)  
Abbey Keener (Education, Columbia University, 2024)  
Taylor Alexander (Education, University of Houston, 2023)

#### *MA Thesis Advising*

Amita Khurana (Sociology, Columbia University, 2024)

#### *Undergraduate Advising*

Kelly Yoshimura (Laidlaw Summer Program, Columbia University, 2023 & 2024)

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & MEMBERSHIPS

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| Fall Conference Program Chair, Sociology of Education Association   | 2024      |
| Session Organizer, PAA Annual Meeting                               | 2024      |
| Board of Directors, Sociology of Education Association              | 2023-2025 |
| Outstanding Publication Award Committee, ASA Section on Methodology | 2023      |
| Program Committee, ABS Annual Meeting                               | 2023      |
| Clifford Clogg Award Committee, ASA Section on Methodology          | 2022      |
| Elected Council Member (Student), ASA Section on Methodology        | 2021-2023 |

### Professional Association Memberships:

American Sociological Association (ASA)  
Association of Black Sociologists (ABS)  
Population Association of America (PAA)  
RC-28: Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility  
Sociology of Education Association (SEA)

**Occasional Reviewer:**

*AERA Open, American Educational Research Journal, American Journal of Sociology, American Sociological Review, European Sociological Review, International Journal of Comparative Sociology, Peabody Journal of Education, Social Currents, Social Forces, Sociological Focus, Sociological Science, Sociology of Education, Socius, The Journal of Higher Education, Time-Sharing Experiments in the Social Sciences (TESS)*